

LE7547: Inner Journey of a Leader

Dr. Banke

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Emotional Maturity Paper

Introduction

In this paper, I will examine my answers to questions from Scazzero's text, *The Emotionally Healthy Church*. I believe I have come from a healthy family and that I grew to be a wonderful person. I have good potential to be a good leader, and that I have skills and the spiritual maturity to be able to be patient and loving, and understand my limits. My weaknesses show that I still have strengths, but that I need to grow in knowledge of real-world ministry experiences. My friend Daniel helped me understand what it is to pastor in LA and his household.

I believe that leading will require me to expand my endurance and knowledge, and that I am on the right track to being a great leader.

Scores from Inventory

Part A: 26

Part B Principle 1: 20

Principle 2: 21

Principle 3: 26

Principle 4: 17

Principle 5: 19

Principle 6: 18

Principle 7: 18

Lowest Scores

Lowest scores were Principles 4 and 6. This is about the Gift of Limits. As I read the chapter in the textbook, I realized that many people want help, but many of them will pull the helper until the helper dies along with them.

I experienced this in my own life. I was poor, but I had purses with holes in them. Even if people were to give me money and support me, it would not truly help me. I needed to finally reach the point where I said, “Hey, blessed are the poor,” and when I did that, my spiritual state changed from seeking riches and fighting poverty to embracing myself and being happy no matter what.

If we are seeking for some sort of thing or happiness, it may allude us. We need to reach rock-bottom and then allow the Spirit of God to pull us up. If other people start helping before a person reaches rock-bottom, then this person will forever rely on the other person for help.

Thus, what I realized was that I need to learn that I cannot control everything. I need to let things fall. I need to exert less energy not more.

The plan for growth is that I want to be able to trust God more instead of trying to control everything. I must limit my strength and my effort and focus on what truly matters and let God control what I cannot control.

And for principle 6, it is about putting yourself in other people’s situations - in other words, “Loving Well.”

And so when I read the textbook, it spoke of Martin Luther King Jr., who was in Birmingham Jail and he wrote that letter. It was a powerful letter that described the injustices that

blacks faced. And the conclusion of the textbook was that we need to walk in other people's shoes in order to understand them.

And this is the most important thing when loving others - to understand them for who they are. We are not to judge them, we are not to try to change them into some image we are comfortable with. We are to love them for who they are and bring out the positives in their characters.

Now, I want to challenge the textbook by saying that, we need to conform others to the image of Christ. This means that we need to rebuke and correct and shape and mold our disciples or our neighbor. You see, people don't know what the correct answer is, and as Christians, we have many good role models and have a clear understanding of what good is and who God is and what we are supposed to be like because we have the Church. We need to correct and shape and mold people to Christ, and this begins with leadership.

And also, I want to say that we cannot just love people and let them be themselves if they are in sin.

I want to grow in this area by having the courage to correct people. I want to have the endurance and patience to be able to love people even when they bring friction into my life.

Share Time

I shared my two weaknesses with my friend and Pastor Daniel. He gave me very insightful real world examples of the situations that pastors face in these two areas.

The two areas, to repeat, are "Limit of Gifts," and "Loving Others."

In regards to the first, he said that there are some people who are homeless - a lot of people in Los Angeles, who need homes, jobs, etc. And we cannot help all of them, or even

some. We just don't have the capability, resources, or time, or knowledge. We need to outsource this to other places like the Dream Center.

He pointed out a very valuable point that we need to understand: when we cannot do things on our own, we need to get the help of others.

This applies to my leadership abilities because I may not be able to do everything on my own. I need someone to do construction in my church. I need someone to mop the floor. I need to work as a team.

I cannot do everything.

And in regards to the latter point, he said that loving others involves rebuking and correcting. If we truly love someone, we should be able to correct them and keep them away from evil. He gave the example of his kids wanting candy, all the time. He cannot possibly let this happen, he has to say, "Only sometimes! Not all the time!" And he said, he needs to hide the candy or keep it away, or just tell them, "No."

This applies to my leadership because I must know that it is not wrong to correct someone or to rebuke them. It is actually loving to do so, according to Daniel. We must guide them on the right path, and prevent them from going to evil. I need to have the courage to step up and say what I need to say. If I don't, seeds of evil will sprout and grow. I must stamp it out at the root. And keep correct doctrine and good works in my organization.

10 Questions

1) Brother: kind, generous. Mom: loving, understanding. Dad: strong, courageous.

2) Parents' marriage is very good. They are loving and kind, but they have times when they argue and don't understand each other. They say they want to divorce at times, but I know

they love each other deep down inside, and also the family is blessed. I think they need to improve on communication and my dad needs to be more loving and caring and kind at times. My dad usually leads the family and the marriage, and the mom doesn't have any input. And whenever she tries to say anything, she is hit with many insults and with hatred.

3) Conflict is handled with anger and insults. When I was younger, I may even have been physically hurt, but I don't remember. It was a very stressful time when I was young, I remember. In our family, we usually don't say anything when there is conflict and try to resolve it in our own hearts. But when there is actual conflict, there is yelling, and throwing of things, etc.

However, that is the past. And in my extended family, I have no conflict. We manage and create an atmosphere of, "We understand each other, and we will keep conflicts to a minimum."

As Koreans, we hold to traditional and conservative styles of gender roles and all sorts of customs.

4) We don't have too many divorces in our family, but we do. We have depression, and we have lack of careers. We struggle to live in America as foreigners, and my cousin had a cancerous thing.

I personally have mental illness, with schizophrenia. My grandmother also had severe anxiety because of the Korean War.

5) We don't talk about feelings too much. We are a friendly and loving family, but we don't share too much deeply what's on our heart. We love each other very much though, but we keep to ourselves.

I personally have opened up and share a lot of myself, but I know when to be quiet and know what kinds of things to say at the right time.

6) Sexuality was not talked about at all. My dad seemed to be loose about it, but he was very conservative and a good person. My parents' marriage was solid, and so there was no bad sexual immorality. We are sexually pure. But I have to say that I fell into pornography, and that I watched many bad things. I was never warned about it and never told not to watch it when I was younger. I was a sheep that was led astray by my middle school friends.

7) There were no family secrets. We are a good family. But, it is possible that my dad stole some equipment or got ill-gotten treasure.

8) Success in my family was going to the right college and living well in America. I also want to make a lot of money, which is something that the family wanted as well - especially my dad. My mom much less. My mom didn't care about success too much; she became very Bible-oriented and just wanted to love me.

9) Money was used frugally. We made reasonable amounts of money, maybe even a lot when I was in high school and middle school and elementary school.

Spirituality was handled well in the sense that my mom was very spiritual and strong, and my dad was fundamentally at his core a good Christian, but he was bad Christian on the exterior. This is the same situation as it is today, where he doesn't go to church anymore and says bad things about the church at times and Christianity, but he is fundamentally a Christian.

Holidays we would always go driving to Las Vegas or to some place.

We had very few relationships with extended family; however my grandmothers and cousins would visit our home in California occasionally.

10) Being Korean shaped us a lot. When I was young, I spent time only with Koreans and went to a Korean church. However, in California, I started to hate myself for being Korean because people would make fun of me. Thus, I ended up with no friends.

I live in Korea now, and I embrace being Korean. I think that being Korean allowed us to be traditional and conservative - to have good spirituality and be good Christians.

It caused my dad to be out of control and my mom to pray in silence. This is the typical Korean family.

For the dad to be honored as king, and mom to be a slave and honor the dad.

And the kids running around in fear and hiding under the tables.

Being Korean means that we study hard and go to the best colleges.

11) I ended up becoming a hero who said, "Okay, I've had enough. I'm saving myself and saving our family." I ended up studying very hard, and working very hard everyday. I exercised and kissed up to my dad, who held the power, and my dad helped me a lot. My dad and I became kind of buddies in high school, and we developed a company that made a good amount of money.

At first, I was a scapegoat, but when I pulled myself up by the bootstraps, I became the turn-around piece that went from zero to one-hundred.

Everything became about me, later on.

12) My dad would always smoke cigarettes, and I would always watch pornography. I would be obsessed with electric guitar and computers. My brother is obsessed with video games.

13) I heard that my mother gave birth to a stillborn child before my older brother. Also, I had schizophrenia and social anxiety.

How My Family Shaped Me

1) My family has caused me to love others so much, and allow me to be a great person.

My family is a wonderful good family. I believe that because it was so difficult growing up, that I became a strong and healthy and good person.

I am morally good, but also spiritually good, and also skilled.

There are two patterns that emerge: being a good kid and being a driven kid.

The first was driven by my parents. They wanted me to be a good kid. But being driven and successful was caused by something we cannot expect. I'm not sure how it happened, but it happened because there was freedom, difficulty, and opportunity.

2) My past is long gone. I understand that my past has shaped my future, and that many good things are in my past, but I don't let my past drag on or drag my present or future down in a negative way. I'm a very positive person.

However, I think this is a very valuable question because recently I was thinking about an incident where a man yelled at me in the streets of LA. He was very angry because he was on a bicycle. But I felt a spiritual release from his stronghold because I believe he may have passed away. This is an example of how the past can grip my present, but now I've been set free.

3) I need to constantly endure and learn Korean and learn how to do ministry. I have to learn how to be humble and keep going even though it may be drudgery. I need to be content even though I don't have much money.

I need to continue on, and learn and grow and be driven. I may finish my education soon, which means that I need to think about what job I will get and how I will do my ministry.

Bibliography

Scazzero, Peter. *The Emotionally Healthy Church: A Strategy for Discipleship That Actually Changes Lives*. Updated and expanded edition. Grand Rapids, MI: Zondervan, 2010.